

» LORD'S TEST
INDIA W-ENGLAND W



REUTERS

History wears white

India's **emphatic victory** over England in the maiden women's Test at Lord's provided the perfect sporting script, but the bigger story was women's cricket finally claiming its rightful place at the Home of Cricket.

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Many have entered cricket's most hallowed ground through the Heyhoe Flint Gate over the past four years. However, that gate assumed even greater significance than it had earlier this month.

Though the MCC paid tribute to Rachel Heyhoe Flint, one of the

pioneers of women's cricket, by renaming the Eastern Gate after her, Lord's had never hosted a Women's Test match. The wait of 239 years was finally over for the women in white.

You could see it on the faces of the 50-odd former England women cricketers who were given the honour of ringing the five-minute bell. You could also see it on the faces of the female cricket fans who queued up outside Lord's well before

the first ball of the first Women's Test was bowled.

And Lord's was ready for the momentous occasion, the historic Test between England and India. It was scheduled to get underway just five days after the final of the Women's T20 World Cup.

The Englishwomen had played that final against Australia and were soundly beaten. They had just a few days to recover and prepare for the completely different demands of Test